

Arabic Grammar for Understanding Quraan¹ Summary

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Chapter Outline

Introduction to Verb Family

Table 1: Arabic Verb Conjugation Chart

From I	Derived To	Derived Form	Example	Comment (if)
فَعَلَ	Form I	فَعَلَ		Basic Form
فَعَّلَ	Form II	فَعَّلَ	عَلَّمَ (he learned) → عَلَّمَ : to teach sb.	Causative & Intensity
فَعَلَ	Form III	فَاعَلَ	جَاهَدَ :he struggled	
فَعَلَ	Form IV	أَفْعَلَ	نَزَلَ (he sent down) → أَنْزَلَ :he sent down	(widely used)
فَعَلَ	Form V	تَفَعَّلَ	ذَكَرَ (he remembered) → تَذَكَّرَ :he received advice	
فَعَلَ	Form VI	تَفَاعَلَ	سَأَلَ (he asked) → تَسَاءَلَ :he asked	both parties involved
فَعَلَ	Form VII	اِنْفَعَلَ	اِنْقَلَبَ :he turned around	
فَعَلَ	Form VIII	اِفْتَعَلَ	اِهْتَدَى → هَدَى :he was guided	
فَعَلَ	Form IX	اِفْعَلَّ		Rarely used
فَعَلَ	Form X	اِسْتَفْعَلَ	اِسْتَغْفَرَ → غَفَرَ :he asked forgiveness	

Basic Verb Conjugation Form I: فَعَلَ He did

- Verb فَعَلَ He did
- فَعَلَ format is called **Form I** or Base Form.
- Root Letters¹ are:
ف ع ل

Present Tense	الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ	Past Tense	الفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي	Person
يَفْعَلُونَ	يَفْعَلُ	فَعَلُوا	فَعَلَ	They-He
تَفْعَلُونَ	تَفْعَلُ	فَعَلْتُمْ	فَعَلْتَ	You(all)-You
نَفْعَلُ	أَفْعَلُ	فَعَلْنَا	فَعَلْتُ	We-I

Nouns			Commands	
Act	Affected	Doer	Plural	Singular
فَاعِلُ	مَفْعُولُ	فِعْلُ	إِفْعَلُوا	إِفْعَلْ Positive
تَفْعَلُ (she does)	فَعَلْتَ (she did)		لَا تَفْعَلُوا	لَا تَفْعَلْ Negative

¹ Almost all verbs have 3 root letters

Basic Verb Conjugation Form I: نَصَرَ He helped

- Verb
نَصَرَ He helped
- فَعَلَ format is called **Form I** or Base Form.
- Root Letters¹ are:
ن ص ر

Present Tense الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ		Past Tense الفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي		Person
Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	
يَنْصُرُونَ	يَنْصُرُ	نَصَرُوا	نَصَرَ	They-He
تَنْصُرُونَ	تَنْصُرُ	نَصَرْتُمْ	نَصَرْتَ	You(all)-You
نَنْصُرُ	أَنْصُرُ	نَصَرْنَا	نَصَرْتُ	We-I

Nouns			Commands	
Act	Affected	Doer	Plural	Singular
نَصَرَ	مَنْصُورٌ	نَاصِرٌ	أَنْصُرُوا	أَنْصُرْ Positive
تَنْصُرُ (she helps)	نَصَرْتَ (she helped)	لَا تَنْصُرُوا	لَا تَنْصُرْ Negative	

¹ Almost all verbs have 3 root letters

Basic Verb Conjugation Form I: جَعَلَ He made/did

- Verb
- جَعَلَ He made
- فَعَلَ format is called **Form I** or Base Form.
- Root Letters are:

ج ع ل

Present Tense الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ		Past Tense الفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي		Person
Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	
يَجْعَلُونَ	يَجْعَلُ	جَعَلُوا	جَعَلَ	They-He
تَجْعَلُونَ	تَجْعَلُ	جَعَلْتُمْ	جَعَلْتَ	You(all)-You
نَجْعَلُ	أَجْعَلُ	جَعَلْنَا	جَعَلْتُ	We-I

Nouns			Commands	
Act	Affected	Doer	Plural	Singular
جَعَلُ	مَجْعُول	جَاعِلٌ	اجْعَلُوا	اجْعَلْ Positive
تَجْعَلُ (she makes)	جَعَلْتُ (she made)		لَا تَجْعَلُوا	لَا تَجْعَلْ Negative

¹ In- The Quran the word appears 346 times

Basic Verb Conjugation Form I: ذَكَرَ He remembered

- Verb
ذَكَرَ He remembered¹
- Form I or Base Form.
- Root Letters are:
ذ ك ر

Present Tense الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ		Past Tense الفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي		Person
Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	
يَذْكُرُونَ	يَذْكُرُ	ذَكَرُوا	ذَكَرَ	They-He
تَذْكُرُونَ	تَذْكُرُ	ذَكَرْتُمْ	ذَكَرَتْ	You(all)-You
نَذْكُرُ	أَذْكُرُ	ذَكَرْنَا	ذَكَرْتُ	We-I

Nouns			Commands	
Act	Affected	Doer	Plural	Singular
ذِكْرٌ	مَذْكُورٌ	ذَاكِرٌ	أَذْكُرُوا	أَذْكُرُ Positive
تَذْكُرُ (she remembers)	ذَكَرَتْ (she remembered)		لَا تَذْكُرُوا	لَا تَذْكُرُ Negative

¹ In The Quran the word appears 163 times

Basic Verb Conjugation Form I: عَبَدَ He worshiped

- Verb

عَبَدَ He worshiped¹

- Form I or Base Form.

- Root Letters are:

ع ب د

Present Tense الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ		Past Tense الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي		Person
Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	
يَعْبُدُونَ	يَعْبُدُ	عَبَدُوا	عَبَدَ	They-He
تَعْبُدُونَ	تَعْبُدُ	عَبَدْتُمْ	عَبَدْتَ	You(all)-You
نَعْبُدُ	أَعْبُدُ	عَبَدْنَا	عَبَدْتُ	We-I

Nouns			Commands	
Act	Affected	Doer	Plural	Singular
عِبَادَةُ	مَعْبُود	عَابِدُ	أَعْبُدُوا	أَعْبُدُ Positive
تَعْبُدُ (she worships)	عَبَدَتْ (she worshiped)		لَا تَعْبُدُوا	لَا تَعْبُدُ Negative

¹In The Quran the word appears 143 times (Ref.

Basic Verb Conjugation Form

We will concentrate on the following high frequency verbs:

1. كَفَرَ [L-17] He disbelieved
2. وَجَدَ [L-21] He found
3. قَالَ [L-22] He told
4. كَانَ [L-23] He was***
5. أَمَرَ [L-25] He ordered
6. أَتَى [L-26] He came
7. شَاءَ [L-26] He wished
8. نَزَلَ [L-30] He sent down
9. كَذَّبَ [L-30] He lied/denied
10. أَخْرَجَ [L-33] He brought out/took out
11. أَسْلَمَ [L-34] He submitted
12. أَنْزَلَ [L-35] He revealed

Note: L-NN is the NN lecture pdf posted in classroom